

# Health and Safety Policy

## General Policy Statement:

**This is the Health and Safety Policy Statement of  
Euphoric Circus CIO**

Our commitment to health and safety is:

- To provide adequate control of the health and safety risks arising from our work activities;
- To consult with our employees and volunteers on matters affecting their health and safety;
- To provide and maintain safe equipment;
- To ensure safe handling and use of substances;
- To provide information, instruction and supervision for employees and volunteers;
- To ensure all employees and volunteers are competent to do their tasks and to give them an adequate induction and training;
- To prevent accidents and cases of ill health;
- To maintain safe and healthy working conditions; and
- To review and revise our policy as necessary at regular intervals.

**Signed Toni Spence  
(for and on behalf of the Euphoric Circus Committee)**

**Position** Development officer

**Date** 14<sup>th</sup> May 2024

**Review date** 14 May 2025



## **Accidents and Incident Procedures:**

### **Minor Accident Procedure**

Euphoric Circus has an accident report book which complies with the new data protection legislation effective from December 31<sup>st</sup> 2003. It is to be kept in a locked filing cabinet and will be updated by Toni Spence.

All staff should know how to report accidents and where to access the forms. the location of the accident report forms allocated to them and how to access them.

### **'Near Miss' Reporting**

Any activities resulting in a 'near miss' must be passed on to the Management Committee. It is most important for staff to own up to any oversights as without this information the system cannot be changed – Euphoric Circus aims to encourage staff to come forward with this information and promotes a climate of development rather than blame.

### **Major Accident Investigation and Reporting to RIDDOR**

All staff will inform Toni Spence of any major accident/dangerous occurrence immediately by telephone and will await further instructions.

Examples of major injuries include fracture of any bone (excluding fingers and toes), amputation, penetrating injury to the eye, any injury resulting in burns or lack of consciousness.

It is the policy of Euphoric Circus to comply with the Reporting of Injuries, Diseases and Dangerous Occurrences Regulations 1995 (RIDDOR 95).

## **Activities, Events and Trips:**

All staff will ensure that health and safety is a key factor when planning any activity or event (this might be a one-hour session, a series of workshops, a camp, staff training, a trip out etc.) and will allocate appropriate time to ensure the following have been carried out:

- Risk assessments have been written and approved by the Management Committee at least three weeks before the event (if necessary)
- Health and consent forms have been returned to the event organiser in good time.
- A team meeting of all staff and additional helpers (if applicable) involved to share information from the risk assessments and discuss the event.

### **Things to think about when planning activities, events and trips:**

- Who will be responsible for collecting the health and safety information and completing the risk assessments?
- Break the event down into:
  - the premises being used
  - the different activities (Including lunch time etc)
  - qualifications needed to run certain events (like rock climbing or canoeing)
  - the necessary ratios of adults to young people
  - do not forget to risk assess the transport issues if you are transporting young people or workers to an event
  - include emergency evacuation procedures and so on. The hazard identification and risk assessment form in this guidance pack provides lots of questions to help you do this.
- Build time into your planning to do all of this thoroughly. Once you have done it, you can use your previous planning and risk assessments to help you the next time round.
- You may also need to leave enough time for other staff to provide you with a copy of their DBS check, the fire certificate or risk assessments from a contracted worker/organisation.

## **Consultation**

Euphoric Circus views communication between staff at all levels as an essential part of effective health and safety management. Consultation will occur by means of Health and Safety update meetings/training to be held annually or more often if deemed necessary. The purpose of these meetings is to provide a forum in which information may be shared and staff's questions on health and safety issues answered. In addition, these meetings will provide an opportunity to assess the continuing effectiveness of the policy. Euphoric Circus will aim to ensure that all staff are included in the consultation process and that ample time is provided for the process to be meaningful.

## **Contractors/Visitors/Volunteers:**

### **Contractors**

Before commencing any work on behalf of or for Euphoric Circus, all contracted workers/freelancers should undergo a health and safety induction as part of their working agreement and arrangements.

It is important to check out the competence and qualifications of the people you have brought in to deliver an activity. If unsure of the required qualifications then the relevant information can be sought from Cumbria youth alliance. For example, outdoor activity contractors or freelancers should have been inspected by the Adventurous Activities Licensing Authority (AALA) and will have a certificate to prove it.

Time should be allocated for this induction – the person should not just turn up and commence work.

If a contractor is providing their own session equipment and/or taking the lead role then they should provide their own risk assessments and public liability insurance.



## **Volunteers**

Any contractor/volunteer working on behalf of Euphoric Circus is Euphoric Circus's responsibility and must be adequately supervised/monitored. They must not be given responsibilities beyond their ability. Volunteers must be identifiable as such by prominently wearing a badge.

## **Visitors**

Visitors to a Euphoric Circus premises or event are the responsibility of Euphoric Circus. Their presence must be taken into account when designing emergency evacuation plans and writing risk assessments. Particular attention must be paid to those who are vulnerable.

## **Control of Substances Hazardous to Health (COSHH)**

It is the policy of Euphoric Circus to comply with the law as set out in the Control of Substances Hazardous to Health Regulations 2002.

## **Cleaning agents**

- Staff must examine manufacturer's warning labels and store accordingly. For example, washing up liquid is not subject to COSHH regulations but bleach is.
- All hazardous cleaning agents must be kept in a locked store cupboard and only official workers or contracted cleaning organisations may have access to the keys.
- No cleaning agents must ever be left unattended (even during cleaning process).
- If young people are involved in cleaning then they must be supervised. Staff are responsible for supervising and ensuring all equipment is locked away.
- Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) should be used if appropriate (mask, rubber gloves).

### **Office equipment/stationery/art materials/paint**

- People ordering equipment should endeavour to use non-toxic varieties. Manufacturers labels must be checked and items must be appropriately stored as above.
- PPE must be considered for all workers and young people using paint (masks, gloves, overalls) if appropriate.

If in any doubt of using or storing certain materials staff should consult [www.coshh-essentials.org.uk](http://www.coshh-essentials.org.uk).

### **Emergency Procedures:**

Toni Spence will draw up emergency procedures in order to deal with an emergency situation at any office base and any other premises regularly used.

This will be conveyed during induction and training and if there are any changes made to the plan.

All staff must have created emergency procedures for any activity that they co-ordinate and these plans must be conveyed to all other staff (including contractors and other helpers) at a briefing session before the activity or event commences.

Each emergency procedure plan must nominate a 'competent person/s' who will implement the plans, this will include removing and checking any visitors books. At an activity the nominated person should be the lead worker or event co-ordinator. In an office environment, two people should be nominated to cover any absence.

### **Fire Safety**

Every non-domestic premises that Euphoric Circus works from requires an individual fire risk assessment and every activity/event that Euphoric Circus delivers will consider fire safety as part of its risk assessment.

## **Responsibility**

- Fire Safety Certificates previously issued by Fire Authorities are **no longer valid**. Any existing Fire Certificate, however, should not be destroyed as it will form a useful guide to existing fire precautions in the building for which it was issued. It is the owner/occupier or person with control of the premise who is responsible for the fire safety procedures, undertaking the fire risk assessment and right adequacy of fire fighting equipment.
- All staff have a duty to report immediately any fire and/or smoke to the fire service (dial 999).
- All staff have a duty to conduct their operations in such a way as to minimise the risk of fire. This involves taking care when lighting a fire; keeping combustible materials separate from sources of ignition and avoiding unnecessary accumulation of combustible materials.

**Fire detection/warning systems** must be in place. This may be a verbal shout/horn/bell as long as it can be heard in all areas of the building. If not, a more sophisticated electronic fire detection/warning system will be put in place. Toni Spence is responsible for ensuring these are in place and regularly maintained (by ensuring it is in the lease agreement or by making regular checks).

## **Fire Fighting Equipment**

- Fire extinguishers must be located at strategic points throughout the workplace. There should be at least 1 for every 200m<sup>2</sup> of floor space and at least 1 on every floor. They should be multi use or specifically designed for the most likely type of fire hazard in that area (e.g. electrical in offices).
- Fire blankets should be present in kitchens if appropriate.
- Toni Spence is responsible for ensuring enough appropriate firefighting equipment is in place and in good working order (by ensuring it is in the lease agreement or by making regular checks).
- Staff should only tackle a fire themselves only if it would pose no threat to their personal safety to do so. If the situation is dangerous or potentially dangerous they should activate the alarm and evacuate the building immediately.

## **Fire Exits and Escape Routes**

- Fire exits must be located at strategic points throughout the workplace and clearly signposted.
- Exit doors must never be locked and must be capable of being opened without the use of a key for as long as the building is occupied. Corridors which are on designated fire routes must not be blocked or used as storage space. Where there are more than 50 individuals likely to use a particular fire exit, this exit must open outwards.
  
- Emergency evacuation procedures must identify at least 1 escape route but preferably more.
- If only 1 route is possible all the doors along the route must be fire resistant and an automatic fire detection system should be in place.
- Corridors must be free from combustible items e.g. coats, notice boards etc.
- Electrical equipment must not be permanently installed on designated fire routes to final exits.
- Travel distances to exit points should be as short as possible (from the furthest point in a room to the door or protected stairway). If there is only 1 escape route then it should be no more than 18 metres. If there are more than 1 exit points the escape routes can be up to 60 metres.
- Toni Spence is responsible for ensuring fire exits and escape routes are considered when completing the fire risk assessment and creating control measures. Escape routes and exit doors must be clearly outlined in the emergency evacuation procedure.

## **Smoking**

- Since 1<sup>st</sup> July 2007 it is against the law to smoke in virtually all enclosed public places, workplaces and public and work vehicles. There will be very few exemptions.
- Indoor smoking in virtually all public places and workplaces is not allowed.





## **Emergency Evacuation Procedure**

In the event of the fire alarm being activated, or in any other emergency situation (such as a bomb scare), everyone must leave the building by the nearest available exit and assemble at the designated assembly point. The designated assembly points for each department are listed on display boards at the separate venues.

Practice fire drills will be conducted annually by Euphoric Circus to ensure familiarity with emergency evacuation procedures.

## **Fire Safety Risk Assessments**

- Fire risk assessment will be made for each occupied building and where necessary, for each activity. On top of premises risk assessments - every activity-based risk assessment should consider 'fire' as a potential hazard and where appropriate include specific control measures.
- Euphoric Circus's standard risk assessment form can be used as normal but specific attention should be given:
  - When identifying hazards - to sources of ignition, oxygen and fuel.
  - When identifying people at risk – to numbers in the building, people with special needs (very young or very old, people with disabilities and pregnant women).
  - When evaluating the level of risk and determining practical control measures – to cost effective solutions staying in line with organisational policy. Consider removing or reducing the fire risks and the risk to people – detection and warning, fire fighting, escape routes, signs and notices, lighting and maintenance.

## **First Aid:**

First aid stations are located with our kit box. All stations are clearly marked and are easily accessible by all during working hours.

When an activity occurs off site – the lead member of staff (if more than one person involved) will take a fully stocked first aid box and accident report forms or designate another colleague to do so.

There should be at least one worker at every session who is designated the 'first aider'.

Toni Spence is responsible for the proper use and maintenance of each first aid station or kit.

A list of emergency telephone numbers of doctors and hospitals available to the work site is kept in each first aid box.

**Large First Aid Kit Minimum Contents:** HSE leaflet 'Basic advice on first aid at work', 20 individually wrapped sterile adhesive dressings (assorted sizes), 2 sterile eye pads, 4 individually wrapped triangular bandages, 6 safety pins, 6 medium sized individually wrapped sterile unmedicated wound dressings (approximately 12cm x 12cm), 2 large individually wrapped sterile unmedicated wound dressings (approximately 18cm x 18cm) and 1 pair of disposable gloves.

### **New Worker Induction:**

All new staff plus contractors and freelancers must go through an induction programme before they commence work for Euphoric Circus. The induction must include:

- Tour of the premises
- Reading the Health and Safety Policy
- Their individual health and safety responsibilities
- First aid arrangements
- Emergency evacuation procedures
- Fire safety
  
- Signatures to say that they have read and understood all health and safety information
  
- **Supervision Ratios (Adults to Young People):**

Euphoric Circus recommends that there has to be a specific number of adults to young persons at any time.



These ratios are different for different ages and circumstances.

The adults may be paid staff or volunteers.

There must be no less than 1 experienced (trained and inducted) member of staff (employee, volunteer or appropriate adult) to every 8 young people unless the young people have particularly challenging behaviour, are vulnerable or have special needs or disabilities. The ratios may then be 1 to 6, 1 to 4 or 1 to 2 as appropriate.

Experienced staff must understand what it means to be the responsible adult in charge of a group of young people – and should have had an induction.

Any amendments to the supervision ratio should be approved by the Management Committee.

### **Record Keeping:**

Records have to be kept for some health and safety protocols. For example, accident report books, copies of certificates and records of induction and training etc should be kept in line with the Data Protection Act.

- Any paper document with 'sensitive data' on it (names and addresses) should be stored in a locked filing cabinet. Accident report books are now designed so that the details can be detached and stored elsewhere.
- Any electronic document with sensitive data should be password protected.

### **Risk Assessment & Hazard Identification:**

Euphoric Circus require a risk assessment for every premises and every activity or event that takes place (this includes using equipment).

Time must be built in to the planning of any activity to allow this to happen properly.



Because every premises and activity is always different, each must have its own unique risk assessment, written during the planning stage of any activity. This should be revisited every time that activity takes place as there may be just one small difference, like a new staff member or a change in the weather for example.

Risk assessment models should be simple, workable and be part of any training and induction programme.

Euphoric Circus staff must follow the 11 step process and use the recommended forms for all Euphoric Circus risk assessments.

### **11 Steps in Risk Assessment**

1. Choose your activity
2. Identify hazards
3. Decide who might be harmed and how
4. Decide how likely it is to happen (L)
5. Look at the severity of it happening (S)
6. Likelihood x severity = Risk (R)
7. Is the risk acceptable?
8. What are the control measures you have to introduce in order to ensure that the risk is acceptable?
9. Assessment of risk after control measures in place
10. Continue to manage risk as things change during the actual activity
11. **SHARE THE RISK ASSESSMENT WITH EVERYONE INVOLVED – BRIEF BOTH WORKERS AND YOUNG PEOPLE**

### **Safe Systems of Work:**

**All staff and committee members should be aware of, respect and adhere to the rules and procedures contained in this particular policy statement.**

### **Working Practices**



- All staff shall immediately report any unsafe practices or conditions to Toni Spence.
  - Any person under the influence of alcohol or any other intoxicating drug that might impair motor skills or judgement, whether prescribed or otherwise, shall not be allowed to work on behalf of Euphoric Circus.
  - Any person whose levels of alertness and / or ability are reduced due to illness or fatigue will not be allowed to remain at work if this might jeopardise the health and safety of that person or any other person.
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- All waste materials must be disposed of carefully and in such a way that they do not constitute a hazard to other people.
  - No one should undertake a job that appears to be unsafe.
  - All injuries must be reported to Toni Spence.
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- Suitable clothing and footwear will be worn at all times. Personal protective equipment should be worn wherever appropriate.

### **Working Environment**

- Areas of work must be kept clean and tidy. No cables/wires are to be left trailing on the floor.
- Any spillage must be cleaned up immediately.
- Waste materials and rubbish must be removed routinely.
- Any premises used for activities must be kept clear from obstructions at all times.
- Where objects are stored, care must be taken to ensure that no long or sharp edges jut out in such a way as to constitute a safety hazard.

### **Training:**

All staff will be trained in safe working practices and procedures prior to being allocated any new role. Training will include policy awareness, advice on the use and maintenance of personal protective equipment appropriate to the task concerned and the formulation of emergency contingency plans.



Training will take place every year and as and when the individual requires training at the discretion of the Management Committee.

Training sessions will provide another opportunity for workers to express any fears or concerns they might have about their role.

Supervisions with staff members will be carried out no less than 6 monthly for workers who are in regular contact with participants.

### **Work Equipment:**

It is the policy of Euphoric Circus to comply with the law as set out in the Provision and Use of Work Equipment Regulations 1998.

Euphoric Circus will endeavour to ensure that all equipment used in the workplace is safe and suitable for the purpose for which it is used. This is the responsibility of Toni Spence.

All staff will be provided with adequate information and training to enable them to use work equipment safely. All work equipment will be maintained in good working order and repair.

All work equipment will be clearly marked with health and safety warnings where appropriate.

### **Workplace and Welfare:**

Euphoric Circus will endeavour to provide suitable and sufficient facilities for employees and volunteers.

This will be reviewed by Toni Spence in the annual audit and will be the responsibility of the Management Committee to ensure that employees/volunteers are running activities in suitable premises and that they meet the requirements of the Disability Discrimination Act.



At each premises there will be:

- Provision of clean hot and cold water, suitable cleansing agents and drying facilities.
- Toilets, sufficient for the number of adults/children. Provision of separate rooms for men and women where there is more than one toilet.
- Provision of wholesome drinking water.
- Ventilation.
- Prevention of smoking.
- Control of room temperatures. 17 – 26 degrees recommended.
- Clean dust free floors.

Staff must contact Toni Spence immediately on suspicion that there is any question as to the safety to the structure or fabric of the premises. Toni Spence must take action immediately. This may involve replacement, closing down operations or temporary relocation.

The Management Committee will ensure that staff are adhering to safe systems of work in order to prevent slips and trips in the workplace.

The safety of shelves, storerooms and filing cabinets etc must be part of the office premises risk assessment.

Any staff members working predominantly outside (detached work for example) must wear appropriate and adequate clothing to protect themselves against adverse weather conditions.

All office space (and shared corridors/kitchens etc) must be clean and hygienic.

### **Monitoring and Review:**

Toni Spence will:

- Annually review and update the health and safety policy 02.07.24
- Annually audit current practice, premises and systems 14.06.24
- Constantly review and change the policy and/or systems in light of certain results/information/feedback from all sources
- Annually lease/consult and train staff is ongoing to review 01.09.24
- Receive and action all accident and near miss forms
- Report on health and safety matters at all Management Committee meetings.